

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-06-18

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 16:1-12

1 Now concerning the collection for the saints, as I have given orders to the churches of Galatia, so you must do also:

2 On the first day of the week let each one of you lay something aside, storing up as he may prosper, that there be no collections when I come.

3 And when I come, whomever you approve by your letters I will send to bear your gift to Jerusalem.

4 But if it is fitting that I go also, they will go with me.

5 Now I will come to you when I pass through Macedonia (for I am passing through Macedonia).

6 And it may be that I will remain, or even spend the winter with you, that you may send me on my journey, wherever I go.

7 For I do not wish to see you now on the way; but I hope to stay a while with you, if the Lord permits.

8 But I will tarry in Ephesus until Pentecost.

9 For a great and effective door has opened to me, and there are many adversaries.

10 And if Timothy comes, see that he may be with you without fear; for he does the work of the Lord, as I also do.

11 Therefore let no one despise him. But send him on his journey in peace, that he may come to me; for I am waiting for him with the brethren.

12 Now concerning our brother Apollos, I strongly urged him to come to you with the brethren, but he was quite unwilling to come at this time; however, he will come when he has a convenient time.

II. Key Summary

- Paul instructs believers to set aside money every first day of the week, proportional to their income, so the collection for Jerusalem's saints is ready when he arrives without needing last-minute fundraising.
 - Paul outlines his travel plans through Macedonia to Corinth, holding them loosely with "if the Lord permits"; he stays in Ephesus because "a great and effective door has opened to me, and there are many adversaries."
 - Paul asks the church to welcome Timothy without intimidating him and to let no one despise him; he also notes that despite his strong urging, Apollos chose not to go to Corinth at that time.
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III. Passage Analysis

Giving Is Something You Plan For, Not React To

"If a man every Lord's day has laid by something, more has been collected — rather than giving everything at once in a single moment." [1]

Paul tells the Corinthians to set their gift aside every week in advance, so that when he arrives, there is no scrambling for money. He specifically says "that there be no collections when I come" — he didn't want people pressured into giving in the moment by the atmosphere of his visit. Thoughtful, proportional giving week by week reflects genuine care, more than a spontaneous decision made under pressure.

Opportunity and Opposition Often Come Together

"Paul also knew that opposition often accompanies opportunities." [2]

Paul didn't stay in Ephesus because it was easy — he says there were "many adversaries." He saw a door God had opened, so he stayed, and the resistance didn't change his direction. This is almost a pattern: the things most worth doing rarely come without pushback.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever wanted to do something you believed was right, but faced opposition or difficulty, and started wondering whether to keep going?

Paul says "a great and effective door has opened to me, and there are many adversaries" — he names both things, and his choice was to stay and keep walking through that door.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Bengel's Gnomon,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/16-2.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-16/>